



Creatorshop

Brand guidelines book

A practical guide for making Creatorshop feel consistent across product, outreach, content, and future brand surfaces.

Creatorshop

Trade posts for software access.
A self serve barter marketplace for creator made content.

Lime
#A3FF38

Lime border
#82F200

Ink
#171717

Paper
#FFFFFF

Soft surface
#FAFAFA

Line
#E5E5E5

Primary action

Accent surface

Use lime as energy, not as paragraph text.

This book is based on the live codebase, product brief, design system entries, and committed brand assets in the repository.

Brand Foundation

Creatorshop is a self serve barter marketplace where creators trade posts for software access and software brands trade product access for creator made content. The brand should feel direct, useful, and a little defiant: the creator has value before anyone hands them a media kit or gatekeeps them by follower count.

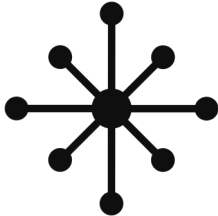
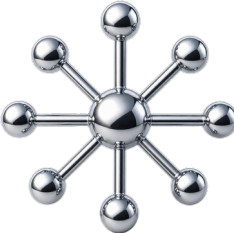
Element	Value	Guideline
Name	Creatorshop	Write as one word with an initial capital. Avoid Creator Shop, CreatorShop, and The Creatorshop.
Audience	Creators first	Prioritize creator clarity while still making brand side value obvious.
Category	Software drops	At launch, describe the marketplace as scheduled software drops rather than a fully stocked always on catalog.
Mechanism	Barter	Creators pay with posts and brands pay with product access. Avoid language that implies cash payouts to creators.
Core unit	Shop	A Shop is the barter workflow: apply, approve, access reveal, deliver, complete.

Positioning: Product Hunt, but creators shop for software by posts.

Use this phrase internally to keep the product sharp. In public copy, unpack it in plain language so people understand the action: browse a drop, apply to a software listing, and pay with content if approved.

Logo System

The Creatorshop mark is a node symbol inside a rounded square. It can be used as the full wordmark from Logo.svg, as a standalone symbol, or as a 3D chrome object in high energy product moments.

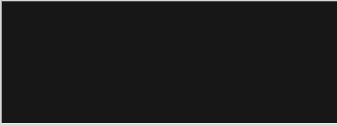
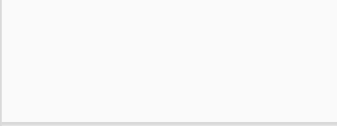
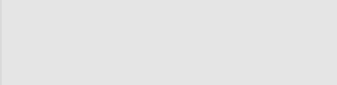
 Primary symbol Black node on lime. Use on white and pale neutral surfaces.	 Metal symbol Use sparingly for premium, cinematic, or launch visuals.
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Logo Rules

Do	Do not
Keep generous clear space around the symbol and wordmark.	Stretch, rotate, crop, or place the mark in a busy image area.
Use lime on white, black on lime, or the supplied full wordmark.	Invent new symbol colors or recolor the wordmark casually.
Use the 3D symbol for scroll moments, launch material, and hero scenes.	Use the 3D symbol as a tiny favicon replacement or inside dense forms.

Color

Creatorshop is mostly black, white, and quiet neutral UI. Lime is the signature burst: it signals energy, action, approval, or the marketplace moment. The codebase includes a global guardrail that prevents green copy from returning, so lime should not be used as normal text.

Swatch	Name	Hex	Usage
	Primary lime	#A3FF38	Use for accent surfaces, badges, activation states, and moments of energy.
	Lime border	#82F200	Use as the structural edge around lime buttons and panels.
	Ink	#171717	Use for main text, primary controls, and high contrast system surfaces.
	Soft surface	#FAFAFA	Use for FAQ blocks, cards, empty states, and secondary UI panels.
	Line	#E5E5E5	Use for borders and quiet dividers.
	Muted text	#737373	Use for supporting explanations and metadata.
	Danger	#DC2626	Reserve for destructive or error states only.

Practical ratio: default to about 70 percent white or soft surface, 20 percent ink and line work, and 10 percent lime. Landing moments may use more lime, but transactional pages should stay calmer.

Typography

Satoshi is the brand sans and should be the default for app UI and marketing prose. Plus Jakarta Sans is the closest working substitute when Satoshi is unavailable in production tools. The app also uses expressive supporting fonts for specific product moments.

Element	Value	Guideline
Primary	Satoshi	Use for body text, navigation, buttons, cards, and product UI.
Fallback	Plus Jakarta Sans	Use in tools that do not have Satoshi available.
Mono	Space Mono	Use for small technical copy, local time, receipt language, and system details.
Pixel	Geist Pixel	Use sparingly for hero statements, glitchy product moments, and launch energy.
Handwritten	Caveat or Permanent Marker	Use only where the product intentionally feels annotated, creator made, or rough drafted.

Type behavior should be compact and readable. Product screens prefer tight hierarchy, generous line height, and no negative letter spacing in compact controls. Hero scale belongs to true hero moments, not dashboards or dense transactional surfaces.

Voice and Messaging

The voice is plainspoken, creator first, and self serve. It should make the barter mechanism feel obvious and legitimate without sounding corporate or inflated.

Element	Value	Guideline
Brand idea	Your content is the new cash	Use as a campaign line or hero expression, not as a legal explanation.
Plain promise	Trade posts for software access	Use when readers need to understand the product fast.
Creator CTA	Browse software drops	Use drop language before launch or when inventory is scheduled.
Workflow	Apply, approve, access reveal, deliver, complete	Use this sequence when explaining the Shop lifecycle.
Brand side	Creator made content for product access	Keep the exchange clear. Brands provide access; creators provide agreed content.

Copy Rules

Do	Do not
Say creators pay with posts, content, or deliverables.	Say creators get paid in cash unless a real cash product exists.
Say no minimum follower count when explaining access.	Promise approval, traction, audience growth, or guaranteed brand deals.
Say software drops before marketplace supply is live.	Pretend there are live listings, testimonials, or traction numbers.
Use direct verbs like browse, apply, unlock, deliver.	Use vague verbs like empower, revolutionize, or transform without proof.

Product UI

The interface should feel like a useful marketplace, not a decorative landing page. Product surfaces are neutral, compact, and structured by borders. Motion and playful effects appear in hero or showcase moments, while checkout, settings, messages, and Shop status views stay restrained.

Element	Value	Guideline
Cards	White or #FAFAFA	Use 12 to 20 px radii for product cards and transactional surfaces.
Buttons	Ink or lime	Use ink for primary high contrast actions; use lime when action energy matters.
Borders	#E5E5E5	Use borders to create structure before adding shadows.
Elevation	Minimal	Avoid dashboard style heavy shadows. The codebase actively removes some older shadows on creator pages.
Status	Badges and dots	Use lime for approved, active, and ready states; keep negative states clear and restrained.

Imagery and Motion

Creatorshop can use visual assets with a strong product signal: the symbol, 3D logo models, creator portraits, software logos, receipt or access metaphors, and interface captures. Pure atmosphere should not replace real product meaning.

Element	Value	Guideline
Hero effects	Pixel trail and text scramble	Use for first impression energy and creator culture references.
3D models	Symbol, floppy disk, pitch bag, deliver symbol	Use for story beats about applying, pitching, and delivering.
ASCII fire	Lime background	Use for high energy launch moments, especially the subscription ditching message.
Creator images	Square portraits	Use for profile and directory contexts, not fake testimonials.
Software logos	Real product marks in mocks	Use only when representing mock examples; avoid implying partnerships.

Motion should support comprehension. Press states can scale slightly, hover states can brighten, and hero elements can scramble or react to cursor movement. Avoid adding motion to dense lists where it slows repeated work.

Naming and Terminology

Use a small vocabulary consistently so the product feels understandable from the first session.

Element	Value	Guideline
Shop	One barter transaction	Capitalize when referring to the product workflow or a user specific deal.
Drop	Scheduled listing release	Use before full supply exists and for launch campaigns.
Access reveal	Approved subscription access	Use after brand approval when the creator unlocks the product details.
Deliverable	The promised content	Use in contracts, product UI, and review states.
Proof	Evidence of posting	Use after a creator publishes or submits completion evidence.

Governance Checklist

Use this checklist before shipping public pages, outreach material, design system changes, or new product screens.

- ☐ The page explains barter without implying cash payouts.
- ☐ The copy does not fabricate live listings, partner logos, testimonials, or traction.
- ☐ Lime is used as surface or action energy, not paragraph text.
- ☐ Satoshi or the approved fallback drives the main UI.
- ☐ A Shop means apply, approve, access reveal, deliver, complete.
- ☐ The creator side feels free and self serve; the brand side remains clear about the \$50 per month tool.
- ☐ Product surfaces prioritize borders, spacing, and compact hierarchy over decorative shadows.
- ☐ Any playful motion is confined to moments that benefit from it.

Source basis: `PRODUCT.md`, `src/app/globals.css`, `src/app/layout.tsx`, component registry entries, app copy, and assets under public.